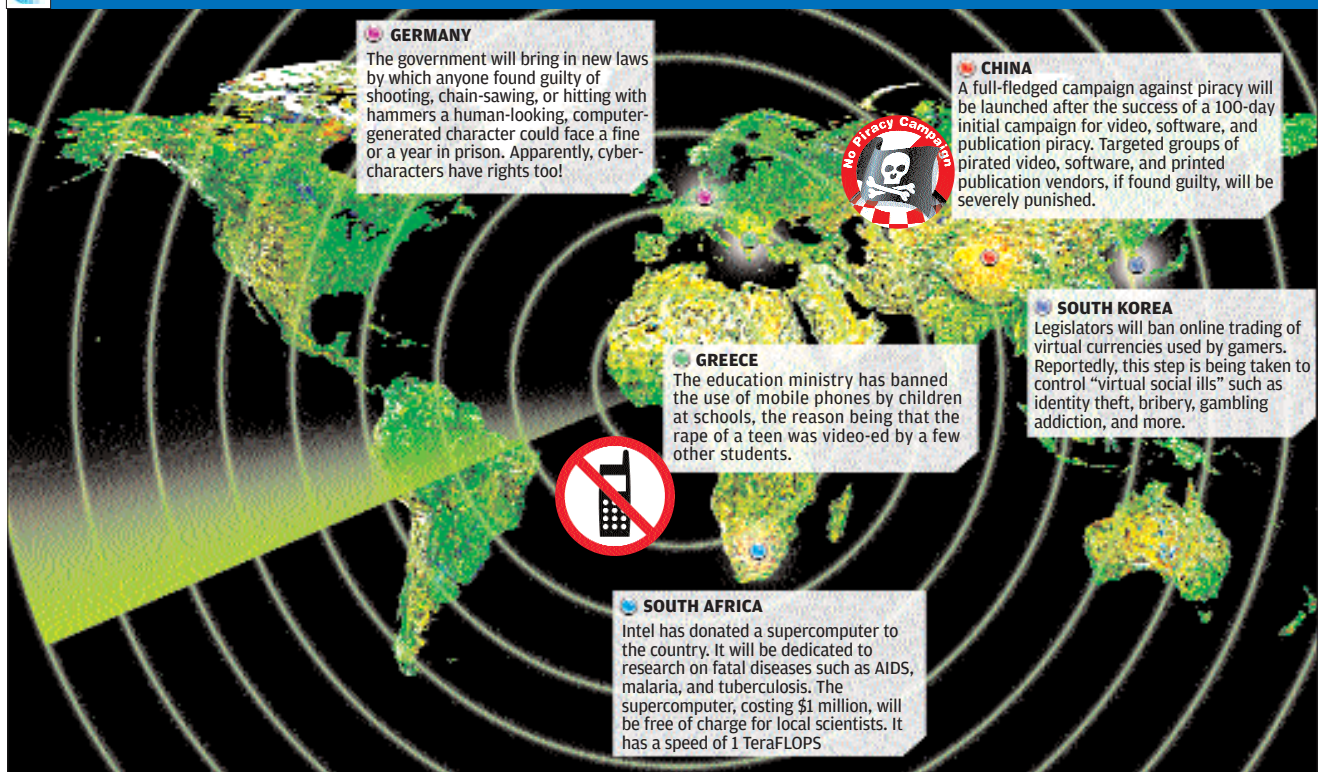




reason, silicon valley has hogged the limelight for good, and "iron oxide valley"—possibly the more important one—will always remain in the shadow.

THEY'VE MADE A DENT

Of Asses And Donkeys

The M. P. Ass. of A. and the R. I. Ass. of A. aren't doing the silly thing anymore—going behind 12-year-old schoolboys and 89-year-old grannies demanding money for filched songs. They're hitting P2P where it hurts.

eDonkey is dead: a New York court ruled that the P2P site did enable users to illegally share copyrighted material. The owners have another P2P network—Overnet—which, too, the court has declared illegal.

The ruling is a major victory for the record labels. Their RIAA has, by now, managed to dent all the major file-sharing networks with the exceptions of

LimeWire and The Pirate Bay. The developers behind LimeWire will soon be hauled to court, too: in November, the RIAA filed suit against LimeWire, and RIAA CEO Mitch Bainwol has gone on to pronounce: "Our settlement with eDonkey will make operations such as LimeWire that continue to break the law... all the more conspicuous." As precedents go, it's a bleak outlook for LimeWire.

In very related news, the MPAA has declared it will launch a legal attack on BitTorrent server operators. This could ultimately prove to be the sock in the b***s for the BitTorrent community, at least the 99 per cent or so of it that comprises illegal-file sharers.

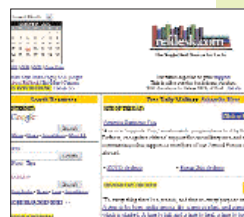
eDonkey.com and Overnet.com now bring up ominous-looking messages: "The eDonkey2000 Network is no longer available. If you steal music or movies, you are breaking the law. Your IP address is xxx.xxx.xxx.xxx and is being



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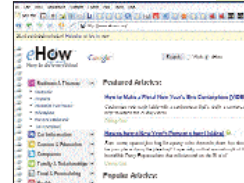
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